11.3 Team charter

The project charter says what the project is allowed to do. The team charter says how the people doing it have agreed to behave, and unlike the project charter it is not signed by anyone above the team. It was drafted by the delivery teams in the week of October 20 and is reviewed every second sprint.

Element	What the team agreed
Team purpose	Build a parking platform that tells drivers the truth about whether a space is free, and give BBGP one place to run 23 facilities. If we cannot count a lot honestly, we say so in the app rather than guessing.
Members	22 people across six delivery teams plus project leadership and field operations. Table 24 names everyone and their allocation.
How we decide	The Product Owner decides scope, the Solutions Architect decides technical approach, the PM decides schedule and budget, and the sponsor decides anything that changes the baseline. Table 25 is the full map. If two of those conflict, the PM calls it and writes down why.
Leadership approach	Democratic by default: the people doing the work size it and choose how. Servant leadership from the leads, whose job is clearing blockers rather than assigning tasks. Authoritative only when a decision is blocking the critical path and the team is genuinely split, and when that happens the PM says out loud that it is happening and why.
Handling conflict	Collaborate first, and look for the option that actually satisfies both sides. Compromise when a decision is time-boxed and the gap is small. Escalate to the PM after two days rather than letting a disagreement sit. We do not use avoidance: an unresolved technical disagreement becomes a design flaw about three sprints later.
Meetings	Daily standup 15 minutes, sprint planning and review every two weeks, retrospective after every review, backlog refinement weekly. Table 22 has the full cadence. Anyone may decline a meeting with no agenda.
Communication norms	Decisions go in writing where the team can find them, not in a direct message. Questions in the open channel, not privately, so the answer is reusable. Reasonable response time is the same working day, and nobody is expected to answer at night or on weekends.
Definition of done	Code reviewed and approved, automated tests passing in CI, deployed to staging and soaked for 24 hours, acceptance criteria met, and the backlog item closed by the merged pull request. Table 21 has the full gate list.
Quality commitments	Two approvals on anything touching payments, reservations, or gate control. No direct pushes to main. Dead code removed within one sprint. No release on a Friday or an event day.
Sustainable pace	No crunch sprints. If a sprint is going to miss, we cut Could priority scope and tell the sponsor, rather than adding hours. Velocity and overtime are reviewed in every retrospective (risk R15).
How we treat each other	Disagree with the idea, not the person. Anyone can say they do not understand something without it counting against them. Whoever is closest to the problem has the most say in how it gets solved, regardless of title.
Charter review	Reviewed at the end of every second sprint. Any member can propose a change; it needs agreement from the team, not approval from the PM.

Table 33: LevelSpot team charter

Two entries in that table were argued about and are worth flagging. The first is the leadership approach: the leads wanted authoritative decision making available at any time, and the engineers wanted it reserved for genuine deadlock. The wording we landed on allows it, but requires the PM to say out loud that it is being used, which is a cost that keeps it rare.

The second is sustainable pace. On a schedule that COCOMO says should take seventeen months and we are running in nine, a no-crunch commitment is easy to write and hard to keep. It is in the charter because writing it down is what makes it possible to point at in February.